reason enough for me a n d for others to act.

But it was not enough to satisfy the questioning that arose within me. W h a t is this India, apart from her physical a n d geographical aspects? W h a t did she represent in the past? W h a t gave strength to her t h e n ? How did she lose that old strength? And has she lost it completely? Does she represent anything vital now, a p a r t from being the home of a vast n u m b e r of h u m a n beings? How does she fit into the modern world?

This wider international aspect of the problem grew upon

me as I realized more and more how isolation was both undesirable and impossible. T h e future that took shape in my mind was one of intimate co-operation, politically, economically, and culturally, between India and the other countries of the world.

But before the future came there was the present, and behind the present lay the long and tangled past, out of which the present had grown. So to the past I looked for understanding.

India was in my blood and there was much in her that instinctively thrilled me. And yet I approached her almost as an alien critic, full of dislike for the present as well as for m a n y of the